

Shivakumar S. Malagihal
Indian Institute of Technology Bombay
+91 9483285260 | shiva.iitbombay.phd@gmail.com | 204270008@iitb.ac.in

Research and Teaching Statement

My research is positioned at the intersection of digital platforms and strategic management. Over the past three years, I have developed a focused research trajectory examining how platform-based firms from emerging economies build capabilities to compete in advanced markets. This work contributes to core areas of strategy and innovation, particularly platform ecosystems, international competitiveness, and institutional dynamics.

I have established a developing portfolio of internationally relevant research outputs that aligns with the REF's expectations of originality, significance, and rigor. My publications include a peer-reviewed article in an ABDC-ranked (B category, Q2) journal exploring how firms extend beyond core activities in the digital platform economy, as well as a book chapter on digital platforms as a source of competitive advantage for ICT firms. I have also presented my research at leading academic forums, including the India Strategy Conference (2025), engaging with contemporary debates on strategy and firm competitiveness. In addition, I have been invited to present my work at the Digital Platform Ecosystem Forum 2026 at the University of Passau (January 15–16, 2026), further strengthening the international visibility and scholarly engagement of my research.

My research pipeline is well developed and strategically aligned with REF output expectations. I currently have multiple working papers at advanced stages, including a manuscript under review at a leading journal (ABDC A category) that examines innovation platform capability and organisational legitimacy. This positions me to deliver 3–4 high-quality outputs within a REF cycle, targeting journals such as the Journal of Product Innovation Management and related high-impact outlets in strategy and innovation.

A key milestone in my research development was my appointment as a Visiting Fellow at the University of Cambridge (2024). During this visit, under the supervision of Prof. Jaideep Prabhu at Cambridge Judge Business School, I conducted a qualitative study examining how an Indian enterprise software firm competes in developed markets. This experience strengthened my international research exposure, enhanced my qualitative methodological expertise, and contributed to my development as an independent researcher working on globally relevant questions in platform-based competition.

Methodologically, my work adopts a mixed-methods approach, combining quantitative techniques (e.g., regression and factor analysis) with qualitative approaches (e.g., case studies and thematic analysis). This enables me to produce research that is both analytically rigorous and contextually rich. My research is designed to deliver impact beyond academia, in line with UK REF expectations, particularly by generating insights relevant to digital platform firms within enterprise software ecosystems and to emerging-economy firms pursuing internationalisation.

My prior professional experience at Capgemini Consulting, Wipro and Volvo USA enables me to connect academic research with industry practice. I actively translate research findings

into actionable insights for practitioners, supporting knowledge exchange and engagement. Looking ahead, I aim to develop REF impact case studies through collaborations with industry partners in digital ecosystems. The Bengaluru context provides a strong empirical setting for examining digital transformation, enabling the development of globally relevant yet locally grounded impact. I am particularly interested in contributing to institutional initiatives related to industry engagement, executive education, and applied research.

My teaching philosophy is centred on research-informed, student-focused, and practice-oriented learning. Over the past three years, I have demonstrated a strong commitment to teaching and student learning. As a Teaching Assistant at IIT Bombay, I have supported the delivery of strategy courses by preparing teaching materials, facilitating discussions, and delivering sessions on digital platforms. I have contributed to the design and evaluation of assessments, ensuring alignment with course objectives and academic standards, and have provided structured and constructive feedback to support student development and learning outcomes.

In my earlier role as a Lecturer, I taught Strategic Management and Project Planning independently, gaining experience in curriculum design, classroom delivery, and student engagement. My teaching approach directly supports the BSBI's expectations for delivering a high-quality student experience and teaching excellence.

I adopt a student-centred approach that emphasises active participation, discussion, and critical engagement. I integrate case-based teaching, drawing on real-world examples—particularly from digital platform firms—to bridge theory and practice. I also adopt a research-led approach by incorporating current research insights into classroom discussions, and I utilise blended learning tools such as Moodle to support continuous engagement.

I am committed to contributing to the academic community through service, collaboration, and collegial engagement. My contributions include peer review activities, support for course administration, and participation in collaborative research. I am keen to contribute to institutional priorities through programme and curriculum development, engagement in departmental and university committees, collaboration with colleagues across campuses, and the development of industry partnerships and external engagement activities.

Over the past three years, I have developed a strong foundation in research, teaching, and academic service, with a clear trajectory towards delivering high-quality outputs, impactful scholarship, and an excellent student experience.